



Warsh vote is set after end of inquiry

Investigation of Fed chair had been key obstacle in nominee's confirmation

BY ANDREW ACKERMAN

A Senate committee moved late Friday to advance Kevin Warsh's nomination to lead the Federal Reserve, scheduling a vote for Wednesday after U.S. Attorney Jeanine Pirro said she was closing a criminal investigation into Fed Chair Jerome H. Powell, potentially removing the main obstacle blocking Warsh's path to confirmation.

Pirro announced Friday on social media that she had ended her probe into Powell and the Fed's \$2.5 billion headquarters renovation, although she said the inquiry could resume if the central bank's inspector general uncovers evidence of wrongdoing. That caveat provoked some wariness on Capitol Hill, where the investigation had come to be widely seen as an abuse of power by the Justice Department, which has pursued President Donald Trump's perceived foes with often shaky allegations of criminal conduct since last year.

The GOP-led Senate Banking Committee scheduled a vote for April 29. Sen. Thom Tillis (R-North Carolina), who had been blocking Warsh's nomination until Pirro stood down her investigation, has not commented publicly on whether he would now support moving the nomination forward. Republicans hold a 13-

SEE WARSH ON A6

Chaos at White House media dinner



MANDEL NGAN/AFP/GETTY IMAGES



NATHAN HOWARD/GETTY IMAGES

TOP: Agents draw guns after bangs were heard during the White House Correspondents' dinner. ABOVE: Guests take cover at the Washington Hilton, where the annual dinner was taking place.

SHOOTING NEAR SCREENING AREA IN HOTEL

Suspect in custody; Secret Service agent in hospital

BY WASHINGTON POST STAFF

President Donald Trump and other guests were evacuated from inside the White House Correspondents' Association dinner on Saturday evening. Guests said there were several loud noises heard inside the ballroom and many people were seen ducking under tables.

Later Saturday night, Trump wrote on Truth Social that a "shooter has been apprehended." The FBI's Washington field office said on social media that a suspect in the shooting outside the event is in custody. Trump said that he, the first lady, Vice President JD Vance and all Cabinet members "are in perfect condition."

The U.S. Secret Service has confirmed it is investigating a shooting incident that took place near the main screening area. The suspect is alive and has been transported to a hospital, according to one U.S. official and one law en-

forcement official.

A Secret Service agent was injured and is in a hospital, a U.S. official said.

"The president and the first lady are safe along all protectees," Secret Service spokesman Anthony Guglielmi said in a statement. "One individual is in custody. The condition of those involved is not yet known, and law enforcement is actively assessing the situation."

Oz Pearlman, the mentalist who was performing at the event, was showing a trick to several members of the head table — including Trump, first lady Melania Trump and White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt — when several booming noises rang out, according to video of the dinner replayed later on C-SPAN.

Many guests evacuated the room. In the half-empty ballroom, people called and texted loved ones to let them know they were safe.

Week of turmoil adds to president's headwinds

BY ISAAC ARNSDORF AND HANNAH KNOWLES

President Donald Trump opened an Oval Office event on Thursday by lamenting that the measure he was announcing to reduce drug prices would probably not lift his political prospects in November.

"By itself we should win the midterms, but it doesn't work that way unfortunately," he said. "It doesn't work that way."

Trump did not specify what was

bringing him down, but it was not hard to guess. On Monday, his labor secretary stepped down in scandal, the third Cabinet secretary to go since March, breaking his effort to avoid the churn and turmoil that dominated his first term.

On Tuesday, Virginia voters approved four more left-leaning congressional districts, canceling out the gains in other states from

SEE TRUMP ON A14

Iran: President scrubs envoys' visit to Pakistan for peace talks. **A14**

Democrats sense shift in their odds of taking Senate

Map still favors GOP, but Trump's low popularity may put feat within grasp

BY ERIN COX

Democrats have long felt bullish about reclaiming the House of Representatives, but a shifting political landscape has also made their once long-shot hopes of winning control of the U.S. Senate more feasible.

High gas prices and declining faith among voters in President Donald Trump's handling of the economy have heightened Republican concern that Democrats could overcome the former's 53-47 advantage.

The GOP remains favored to retain control, given that Democrats would need to win in states that favor Republicans. But those odds have been consistently shifting in Democrats' favor as Trump's poll numbers slide.

"In the first administration, the economy was his superpower," said Lindsey Owens, executive director of the Groundwork Collaborative, a progressive think tank that works on economic issues. "That phenomenon was critical to his reelection. People remembered him as strong on the economy."

But those ratings are plummet-

SEE SENATE ON A2

Several members booted from independent board on science

BY CAROLYN Y. JOHNSON

Multiple scientists who serve on an independent board established to guide the nation's nearly \$9 billion basic science funding agency were terminated from their positions Friday by President Donald Trump.

Members of the National Science Board, which helps govern

the National Science Foundation, were dismissed in a message from the Presidential Personnel Office thanking them for their service, according to screenshots shared with The Washington Post: "On behalf of President Donald J. Trump, I'm writing to inform you that your position as a member of the National Science Board is terminated, effective immediately."

The National Science Board was established in 1950 to guide the governance of the National Science Foundation, in an unusual structure within the federal government that echoes the setup of a company board in the private sector. It helps guide an agency that operates Antarctic research stations, telescopes, a

fleet of research vessels and supports basic science research in laboratories across the United States.

The NSF has a long history of supporting technology and research that powers many innovations the world relies on today. The agency helped language-learning app Duolingo get its start. NSF research has also

helped evolve technology used in MRIs, cellphones and LASIK eye surgery.

The board's members are scientists and engineers from universities and industry and are appointed by the president, but they serve six-year terms, ensuring overlap between different administrations. There are typi-

SEE BOARD ON A9



CAROLINE GUTMAN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Think pub trivia, minus the clothes

Kink N' Draw is part of a growing trend around D.C. where people can shell out a few bucks to draw live, naked models at a bar. Casual and community-oriented. No experience necessary. **Story, B13**

'Rat apocalypse' in Boise spurs legislative deadlock

Idaho lawmakers have spent hours debating surge in rodents that they blame on city transplants

BY KARIN BRULLIARD

BOISE, IDAHO — An invasion of stowaways had arrived from liberal coastal states, the lawmakers asserted. "Decisive action" was needed, one said, to "slash this problem through the heart and stop the proliferation." Failure to act, another warned, would transform Boise and its neighbors in the wider Treasure Valley into nothing less than "sanctuary cities."

The cause of their intense alarm: rats.

In a recent legislative session gripped by cost-cutting and culture war issues, state lawmakers here also spent hours debating a surge in foreign-to-Idaho rodents menacing Boise-area gardens and kitchens and threatening agriculture and public health. Bipartisan bills called for naming two spe-

cies — Norway and roof rats, both native to Asia — as invasive, dangerous and worthy of state action.

Despite pleas for help from local officials, the proposals died amid concerns of government overreach. Even so, the rats' starring role at the Capitol reflected the latest growing pain for a state that has undergone one of the nation's most rapid population booms in recent years. And given that much of the growth since 2020 has been driven by an influx of Californians, it is perhaps no surprise that lawmakers also linked the rats' appearance to migration from blue states.

"What's suspected is that these rats basically hitchhiked in storage containers that would be moving furniture from residences in some major city on the West Coast into Idaho," state Sen. Steve

SEE RATS ON A8

POLITICS & THE NATION

Trump eager to show off his latest White House work to King Charles. **A3**

SPORTS

Ditching defined roles, the Nationals' bullpen is finding its footing. **B1**



BUSINESS

Anti-immigrant bills in red states are failing as businesses balk. **B7**

ARTS & STYLE

A history of the Harvard Lampoon, the magazine that remade comedy.



TRAVEL

Don't sit down at that bar in Madrid, and other tips from José Andrés.

THE REGION

D.C. aims to counter a rise in domestic violence amid a raft of cases. **B13**

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